Real-world (make it feel alive with streaming) — Solution

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Story — `streaming_practice.py`: a normal call waits for the entire reply before showing you anything — for a long answer, that's several seconds of silence. Streaming prints each piece as it arrives, which is the difference between a chatbot that feels instant and one that feels stuck. **If not:** the Build Task's `stream_message()` would be the first time you ever saw a chunk-by-chunk response, with no smaller version to check your understanding against.

Solution

```
# streaming_practice.py
from dotenv import load_dotenv
from openai import OpenAI

load_dotenv()
client = OpenAI()

# Stream a reply: print each piece as it arrives, and return the full text
# at the end so it can be appended to the same history list.
def stream_reply(history):
    stream = client.chat.completions.create(
        model="gpt-4o-mini",
        messages=history,
        stream=True,
    )
    full_reply = ""
    for chunk in stream:
        # each chunk carries one small piece in .delta.content
        # (None on chunks that carry no new text)
        piece = chunk.choices[0].delta.content
        if piece:
            print(piece, end="")
            full_reply = full_reply + piece
    print()
    return full_reply
```

```
# Try it, then append the finished reply to history like a real chat would.
history = [
    {"role": "system", "content": "You are a helpful assistant."},
    {"role": "user", "content": "Explain a REST API in 3 sentences."},
]
reply = stream_reply(history)
history.append({"role": "assistant", "content": reply})
```

Expected output: the reply printed piece by piece as it streams in, and `history` now correctly ends with the assistant's full reply appended.